

SIKAPTala 2026: The National CS & IT Competition

VIRTUAL GAME JAM GUIDELINES

CALENDAR OF ACTIVITIES		
May 11, 2026 (Monday)	10:00 AM - 12:00 PM	Game Jam Orientation
	1:00 PM - Onwards	Game Jam Proper
May 13, 2026 (Wednesday)	1:00 PM	End of Game Jam Development

All activities will be conducted virtually. Official meeting links, submission links, and announcements will be sent to registered participants through their designated Contact Representatives.

I. RATIONALE

The SIKAPTala 2026 Game Jam provides undergraduate students with a national platform to explore game development as a medium for creativity, storytelling, and problem-solving. Through rapid prototyping under time constraints, participants are challenged to transform abstract ideas into playable digital experiences aligned with a given theme.

By integrating programming, design, art, and narrative thinking, the Game Jam promotes interdisciplinary collaboration while highlighting the relevance of games beyond entertainment, such as education, social awareness, cultural expression, and innovation. The competition cultivates technical competence,

creativity under pressure, and teamwork, core competencies essential to future computing professionals.

II. ELIGIBILITY AND TEAM COMPOSITION

1. The competition is open to all currently enrolled undergraduate students in the Philippines, regardless of course or institution.
2. Teams must consist of a minimum of 3 and a maximum of 8 members. Individual entries or teams falling outside of this range will not be identified as valid contestants.
3. Team members may come from different schools, programs, or year levels, provided that they are all undergraduate students.
4. Each team must designate one (1) Contact Representative responsible for official communication with the organizers.
5. A participant may only join one (1) team. Multiple registrations will result in disqualification.
6. All development, submission, and evaluation activities will be conducted entirely online.
7. Participants are responsible for ensuring access to appropriate hardware, software, development tools, and a stable internet connection throughout the duration of the Game Jam.

III. GAME JAM FLOW AND FORMAT

A. Game Jam Orientation

1. The official Game Jam Orientation will be conducted via Microsoft Teams.
2. Registered teams will receive the meeting link through email prior to the event.

3. Attendance is mandatory, as the theme of the Game Jam will be announced during this session. At least one (1) representative from each team must be present.
4. During the orientation, the following will be discussed:
 - 4.1. Official Game Jam Theme
 - 4.2. Competition rules and scope
 - 4.3. Submission requirements and deadlines
 - 4.4. Judging criteria and evaluation process

B. Game Jam Proper

1. The Game Jam Proper will officially begin immediately after conclusion of the orientation.
2. Participants will have uninterrupted development time from May 11, 1:00 PM until May 13, 1:00 PM (Philippine Standard Time, GMT +8).
3. All game concepts, designs, assets, code, and builds must be developed exclusively within this timeframe.
4. No extensions will be granted. All submissions must be completed and uploaded before the deadline regardless of any technical or personal circumstances encountered by the team.

IV. GAME SCOPE AND DESIGN REQUIREMENTS

A. Theme

1. The official Game Jam Theme will be announced during the Game Jam Orientation.

2. All submitted games must clearly interpret and integrate the announced theme. Literal and abstract interpretations are allowed, provided relevance is evident.
3. Teams that fail to demonstrate a meaningful connection to the theme will receive reduced scores under the Theme Interpretation criterion.

B. Anchor Point

All teams are **required** to use **Anchorpoint (anchorpoint.app)** as part of their game development workflow.

Anchorpoint is a version control and asset management tool built on Git, designed for collaborative game development. It is used to track project progress, manage assets, and document development activity throughout the Game Jam period.

Anchorpoint Usage Guidelines

1. Each team must maintain **one (1) Anchorpoint project repository** for their Game Jam entry.
2. All core development files—including but not limited to source code, art assets, audio, and game scenes must be managed through Anchorpoint.
3. The Anchorpoint repository must reflect **active development within the official Game Jam period.**
4. Version history must clearly show:
 - File creation and modification during the Game Jam
 - Contributions from officially registered team members only
5. Anchorpoint must not be used to upload or reuse:

- Previously completed games
- Major gameplay systems or assets developed prior to the Game Jam, unless explicitly permitted and fully disclosed

Failure to comply with this requirement may result in deductions under **Technical Execution** and **Originality**, or **disqualification**, at the discretion of the organizers.

C. Game Requirements

All entries must be original games, created and developed entirely during the official SIKAPTala 2026 Game Jam. Development starts on May 11 at 1:00 PM and ends on May 13 at 1:00 PM.

Each game must be fully playable and include, at minimum:

1. A defined gameplay objective or loop that guides player actions.
2. Functional and responsive player controls.
3. A clear start point and logical end state, such as completion, success/failure, or sandbox-style conclusion.

Games may be developed for any of the following platforms:

- PC (Windows, macOS, Linux)
- Web-based platforms (browser-playable)

Participants are free to use any game engine, framework, or programming language, as long as the final game can be accessed and evaluated by the judges without requiring proprietary or paid software.

For web-based submissions, teams must provide a stable, publicly accessible URL (e.g., via itch.io or a comparable hosting platform). For PC builds, teams must provide a downloadable archive (e.g., .zip) containing all necessary files to run the game without additional installation. All submissions must be

stable, accessible, and optimized for evaluation within the judging period. Games that are incomplete, unstable, or inaccessible may be disqualified.

D. Asset Usage and Originality Policy

1. All third-party or pre-existing assets must be properly and clearly credited in the submission. Asset attributions must include, where applicable, the asset name, creator, source, and license type.
2. The use of game engines, development frameworks, APIs, and general-purpose libraries does not violate originality requirements and is fully permitted.
3. Teams are strongly encouraged to create original assets developed exclusively during the Game Jam period, including but not limited to artwork, animations, music, sound design, narrative content, and code.
4. Additional merit will be given during judging to teams that utilize original assets created specifically for the Game Jam, provided that such originality is supported by complete documentation and verifiable proof of creation. Acceptable forms of documentation may include:
 - 4.1. Source or project files
 - 4.2. Version history or commit logs
 - 4.3. Timestamps or metadata
 - 4.4. Process documentation (e.g., sketches, drafts, iteration logs)

5. Any assets, tools, or reusable code created prior to the Game Jam may only be used if they are:

5.1. Generic in nature

5.2. Not specifically designed for the submitted game,
and

5.3. Fully disclosed upon submission.

6. The use of previously completed games, pre-built game templates with full gameplay logic, or major gameplay systems developed prior to the Game Jam is strictly prohibited.

7. Regarding AI-generated content, teams may use AI-assisted tools (e.g., for ideation, placeholder assets, or code suggestions) provided that all such usage is fully disclosed in the submission.

AI-generated assets will not be credited toward original asset merit. The use of AI tools does not replace the originality requirement, the core game concept, design decisions, and implementation must originate from the registered team

8. Failure to properly disclose asset usage, provide required attribution, or submit sufficient documentation for original assets may result in:

7.1. The exclusion of the asset from originality evaluation, or

7.2. Disqualification, subject to the discretion of the organizers and judges.

9. The organizers reserve the right to request additional clarification or documentation regarding asset usage to ensure compliance with this policy.

E. Fair Play and Conduct

1. All development work must be completed solely by the officially registered members of each team during the Game Jam period.
2. External collaboration or direct development assistance from individuals outside the registered team is strongly prohibited.
3. Participants may consult publicly available documentation, tutorials, and learning resources, but direct implementation assistance from external parties is not allowed.
4. All participants are expected to uphold professionalism, academic integrity, and respectful conduct throughout the competition.
5. Any behavior that compromises the integrity, fairness, or credibility of the Game Jam may result in disqualification.

F. Submission Guidelines

Each team must submit **one (1) playable game** through the official submission platform designated by the organizers. Submissions must include the following components:

1. Game Information

- Title: The official name of the game.

- **Description:** A concise summary highlighting the game's concept, objectives, and unique features.

2. **Gameplay Documentation**

- **Instructions & Controls:** Clear guidance on how to play the game, including player controls and objectives.
- **Gameplay Footage / Demonstration:** Visual or video documentation showing mechanics and game flow.

3. **Team Information**

- **Team Members & Roles:** Full list of registered participants and their respective roles.
- **Team Name:** Official name of the team.
- **Team Logo (*optional*):** A logo representing the team or game.

4. **Asset Disclosure**

- **Full Attribution of Assets:** List all third-party or pre-existing assets used, including name, creator, source, and license type.
- **Original Assets Documentation:** If applicable, provide evidence of assets created during the Game Jam (e.g., source files, commit logs, timestamps, sketches, or drafts).

5. **Supplementary Files**

- **Anchorpoint Repository Link:** A publicly accessible link to the team's Anchorpoint project repository.
- **Game Design Document (GDD):** A viewable PDF outlining the game's core mechanics, story, and technical stack.
- **Game Pitch / Presentation:** A PDF or PPTX (maximum 10 slides) summarizing the game for presentation purposes.

- Tutorial Documentation: A PDF or PNG file illustrating input controls, game goals, and mechanics.

All files must be properly organized and submitted before the official deadline of May 13, 2026 at 1:00 PM (Philippine Standard Time). Late or incomplete submissions will not be accepted.

G. Judging Process

1. All submitted games will be evaluated during the official judging period.
2. Judges will assess entries independently based on the established criteria.
3. Scores will be consolidated to determine final rankings.
4. Judges may request clarification or additional documentation from teams regarding their submissions. Teams must respond within the timeframe specified by the organizers.
5. The decisions of the judges are final and binding. No appeals or score disputes will be entertained after the official announcement of results.

V. CRITERIA FOR JUDGING

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CRITERION	WEIGHT	FOCUS AREAS
Gameplay & Mechanics	30%	Clarity of mechanics, player engagement, overall game flow
Theme Interpretation	20%	Relevance and depth of theme integration, creativity in applying theme

Creativity & Originality	20%	Innovation in concept, mechanics, or presentation, distinctiveness
Technical Execution	15%	Stability, performance, implementation relative to scope/time
Visuals, Audio & Presentation	15%	Cohesiveness, quality of design, user experience
TOTAL	100%	

VI. CONTENT RESTRICTIONS

SIKAPTala 2026 maintains a professional and inclusive environment. Any behavior or content that compromises this may result in disqualification.

- **Nudity & Pornographic Material:** Defined as any depiction of explicit sexual acts, genitalia, or lewd exposure intended for arousal.
- **Racism & Racial Discrimination:** Any content that promotes prejudice, hostility, or stereotypes based on race, ethnicity, or national origin.
- **Sexual Discrimination:** Content that marginalizes or harasses individuals based on their biological sex, gender identity, or sexual orientation.
- **Political/Government Defamation or Advertisement:** Any content that serves to unfairly malign, slander, or libel specific government officials, political figures, or government institutions, or conversely, acts as a campaign tool to promote a specific political candidate, party, or government entity, and the use of official government logos, political campaign slogans, or caricatures intended to incite political hostility is strictly prohibited.

- **Hate Speech & Profanity:** The use of slurs or language intended to dehumanize, degrade, or incite violence against any group or individual.
- **Product or Service Advertisements:** The inclusion of content specifically designed to promote, market, or sell a commercial product, brand, or service for financial gain or corporate visibility, this includes the use of copyrighted corporate logos, QR codes leading to storefronts, or "shout-outs" to commercial sponsors not officially recognized by the SIKAPTala organizers.
- **Gore & Mutilation:** Intensive levels of graphic violence, including dismemberment or exposed entrails, are prohibited.
 - **Note on Blood:** Blood usage must be minimal and non-gratuitous. Puddles of blood or excessive "blood splats" are not permitted.

VII. PARTICIPANT SUBMISSION CHECKLIST

The following is a complete list of all materials each team must prepare and submit through the official submission platform (Google Forms) before May 13, 2026 at 1:00 PM (Philippine Standard Time). Ensure all items are properly organized prior to uploading.

All submitted files must follow the official naming format:

SIKAPTala2026_[TeamName]_[File]

Example: SIKAPTala2026_TeamAlpha_GDD.pdf

PARTICIPANT SUBMISSION CHECKLIST			
DELIVERABLES	DETAILS	WHERE TO UPLOAD	STATUS
Playable Game File	Stable and accessible build (PC or browser-based)	Google Forms (link provided by organizers)	Required

Game Information	Game title and concise description (concept, objectives, unique features)	Google Forms	Required
Gameplay Documentation	Instructions & controls; gameplay footage or video demonstration	Google Forms (video via Google Drive or YouTube link)	Required
Team Information	Unique team name, member names and roles	Google Forms	Required
Team Logo	A logo representing the team or game	Google Forms (image file upload)	Optional
Asset Disclosure	Full attribution for all third party or pre-existing assets (name, creator, source, license)	Included in GDD or uploaded as separate file in Google Forms	Required
AI Tool Disclosure	Declaration of any AI-assisted tools used and their purpose	Included in GDD or Asset Disclosure file in Google Forms	Required if applicable
Original Asset Documentation	Source files, Anchorpoint commit logs, timestamps, sketches, or drafts	Anchorpoint Repository (accessible via submitted link)	If applicable
Anchorpoint Repository Link	Publicly accessible link showing active development history within the Game Jam period	Google Forms (paste repository URL)	Required
Game Design Document (GDD)	PDF outlining core mechanics, story, and	Google Forms (PDF upload)	Required

	technical stack		
Game Pitch / Presentation	PDF or PPTX summarizing the game (maximum 10 slides)	Google Forms (PDF or PPTX upload)	Required
Tutorial Documentation	PDF or PNG illustrating input controls, game goals, and mechanics	Google Forms (PDF or PNG upload)	Required

The organizers reserve the right to amend, clarify, or modify these guidelines as necessary to ensure the smooth execution of the competition. Any updates will be officially announced through authorized communication channels.